FROM THE HOLLIS KITCHEN

The Meal Prep *Cookbook*

RECIPES	CHAPTERS	BUILT FOR
Twenty-five	*Five*	*Glass containers*

WELCOME

Food that actually makes it to *Monday.*

Meal prep shouldn't feel like a second job. The recipes in this book were built around a simple idea — that good food, cooked once on a Sunday, should still taste like something you're glad to open four days later. Every dish here has been tested in the containers you're holding: portioned to fit, seasoned to hold its own after a few nights in the fridge, and forgiving enough that a ten-minute reheat at the desk still feels like a proper lunch, not a sad compromise you eat standing up between meetings.

These recipes are written for the way Australians actually eat — at desks, in utes, on the tools, between sessions. The macros are honest.

The portion sizes are built for an adult who moves. The ingredient lists lean on what you can buy on a Sunday at Coles or Woolies, not a deli you've never heard of. Nothing is fussy, nothing asks for a kitchen scale or a Tuesday afternoon free, and where we've called for a specific technique, it's because it genuinely changes the result — not because it looked good on a page.

— The Hollis kitchen

PERTH, WESTERN AUSTRALIA

HOW TO USE THIS COOKBOOK

1. **Read once, then cook.**
   Skim the full method before you start. Every recipe here fits a single Sunday afternoon.

2. **Portion as you go.**
   Each recipe notes the container size it's built for. Divide straight from the pan while it's still warm.

3. **Cool before you lid.**
   Let food sit uncovered for ten minutes. It keeps the glass clear and the texture right.

4. **Four days, not seven.**
   Most dishes here are best within four days. Freeze the rest — every recipe notes what travels well.

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25 recipes, 5 *chapters.*

Organised by the time of day you'll most likely eat them.

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STORAGE · REHEATING · SWAPS · PLAYBOOK

BREAKFAST · NO. 01

Peanut Butter *Banana* Overnight Oats

Breakfast · 1 serving · 5 min + overnight

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
485 kcal	22 g	58 g	18 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	*Don't*

INGREDIENTS

½ cup	(45g) rolled oats
¾ cup	(180ml) milk of choice
1 tbsp	chia seeds
1 heaped tbsp	natural peanut butter
1 tsp	honey or maple syrup
½	ripe banana, sliced
Pinch	of cinnamon

METHOD

1. Add oats, milk, chia, peanut butter, honey and cinnamon to your container. Stir thoroughly until the peanut butter is dispersed through the mixture.
2. Top with sliced banana and seal the lid.
3. Refrigerate at least 4 hours — overnight is better.
4. Eat cold straight from the container, or stir briefly before serving.

PREP TIP *Batch the week.*

Batch four containers on Sunday night for Monday-to-Thursday breakfasts. Add the banana on the morning you eat it if you prefer firmer slices.

BREAKFAST · NO. 02

Mexican-Style *Egg* Muffins

Breakfast · 4 servings (3 muffins each) · 10 min + 20 min bake

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
295 kcal	22 g	6 g	20 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	2 months

INGREDIENTS

8	large eggs
¼ cup	(60ml) milk
½	red capsicum, finely diced
½	small red onion, finely diced
1	spring onion, sliced

60g	grated tasty cheese
½ tsp	smoked paprika
½ tsp	ground cumin
—	Salt and pepper
—	Olive oil spray

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 180°C fan-forced. Spray a 12-hole muffin tin generously with olive oil.
2. Whisk eggs and milk in a large jug. Season with paprika, cumin, salt and pepper.
3. Divide capsicum, red onion, spring onion and cheese evenly between the muffin holes.
4. Pour the egg mixture over the fillings until each hole is three-quarters full.
5. Bake 18–22 minutes until puffed and set. Cool in the tin for 5 minutes, then transfer to a rack.
6. Once fully cool, portion 3 muffins per container and refrigerate.

> PREP TIP ***Reheat low and slow.***
>
> Reheat in the microwave for 40–50 seconds on medium. If freezing,

> thaw overnight in the fridge before reheating — straight from frozen makes them weep and go rubbery.

BREAKFAST · NO. 03

Coconut *Chia* Pudding with Berries

Breakfast or snack · 1 serving · 5 min + overnight

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
355 kcal	10 g	35 g	20 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
5 days	*Don't*

INGREDIENTS

3 tbsp	chia seeds
¾ cup	(180ml) light coconut milk (carton, not tin)
1 tsp	vanilla extract
1 tsp	maple syrup
½ cup	(75g) mixed berries (fresh or frozen)
1 tbsp	toasted coconut flakes (optional)

METHOD

1. Combine chia seeds, coconut milk, vanilla and maple syrup in your container. Whisk well.
2. Wait 5 minutes, then whisk again to break up any clumps before they set.
3. Seal and refrigerate overnight until thickened to a pudding consistency.
4. Top with berries — and coconut flakes if using — before eating.

> PREP TIP *The second whisk matters.*
>
> That second whisk after 5 minutes is the difference between creamy pudding and a clumpy gel. Don't skip it. Set a timer if you have to.

BREAKFAST · NO. 04

Savoury Breakfast *Burrito* Bowl

Breakfast · 4 servings · 25 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
520 kcal	32 g	42 g	24 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	*Not rec.*

INGREDIENTS

1 cup	(200g) basmati rice, uncooked
400g	lean beef mince (or turkey mince)
1 tbsp	taco seasoning
1 × 400g	tin black beans, drained and rinsed
1 cup	(150g) corn kernels (frozen or tinned)
1 punnet	cherry tomatoes, halved
1	avocado (add on the day)
—	Lime wedges, coriander, hot sauce to serve

METHOD

1. Cook rice according to packet directions. Spread on a tray to cool quickly.
2. Heat a large non-stick pan over medium-high. Brown the mince, breaking it up, for 5–6 minutes.
3. Add taco seasoning and a splash of water. Stir through for 1 minute, then remove from heat.
4. Divide rice, mince, beans, corn and tomatoes between 4 containers, keeping each component in its own section.

5 Refrigerate. Add sliced avocado, lime, coriander and hot sauce on the morning you eat.

> PREP TIP *Keep components separate.*
>
> Keeping ingredients in their own sections means you can reheat the rice and mince for 2 minutes without wilting the tomatoes. Everything hits the bowl hot, cold, or fresh — exactly how it should.

BREAKFAST · NO. 05

Vanilla *Protein* Baked Oats

Breakfast · 4 servings · 10 min + 25 min bake

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
340 kcal	24 g	42 g	8 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
5 days	1 month

INGREDIENTS

2 cups	(180g) rolled oats
2 scoops	(60g) vanilla protein powder

2 tsp	baking powder
2	large eggs
1	ripe banana, mashed
1½ cups	(375ml) milk
¼ cup	(60ml) maple syrup
1 tsp	vanilla extract
Pinch	of salt
—	Handful of blueberries or chocolate chips

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 180°C fan-forced. Line a 20cm square baking dish with baking paper.
2. Whisk eggs, mashed banana, milk, maple syrup and vanilla in a large bowl.
3. Stir in oats, protein powder, baking powder and salt until combined.
4. Pour into the prepared dish. Scatter blueberries or choc chips over the top.
5. Bake 22–26 minutes until set in the middle and golden on top.
6. Cool completely before slicing into 4 portions.

PREP TIP ***Whey dries out. Blend won't.***

Whey-based protein powders can go dry when baked. If that happens to you, switch to a plant-based blend next time — or stick with whey but add 2 tbsp of Greek yoghurt to the wet mix to keep it soft.

Teriyaki *Chicken* & Rice Bowl

Lunch · 4 servings · 25 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
520 kcal	38 g	58 g	12 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	2 months

INGREDIENTS

600g	chicken thigh fillets, diced 2cm
1½ cups	(300g) jasmine rice, uncooked
2 cups	(160g) broccoli florets
1 large	carrot, julienned
1 tbsp	sesame oil
2 tbsp	sesame seeds, to serve
2	spring onions, sliced, to serve

FOR THE SAUCE

¼ cup	(60ml) soy sauce
2 tbsp	mirin

2 tbsp	brown sugar
1 tbsp	rice wine vinegar
2 tsp	cornflour + 2 tbsp water
1 clove	garlic, grated
2cm	ginger, grated

METHOD

1. Rinse rice until water runs clear. Cook to packet, then spread on a tray to cool.
2. Whisk all sauce ingredients except the cornflour slurry in a small bowl.
3. Heat sesame oil in a large pan over medium-high. Add chicken and cook 6–7 minutes until golden.
4. Pour sauce over chicken, bring to a simmer, stir in the cornflour slurry. Cook 1–2 minutes until glossy.
5. Steam or microwave broccoli and carrot for 2 minutes — keep them with bite.
6. Divide rice between 4 containers. Top with chicken and vegetables. Cool fully before sealing.
7. Scatter sesame seeds and spring onion before eating.

> PREP TIP *Cool the rice fast.*

> Hot rice in a sealed container is how meal prep goes wrong — it steams itself gluey by Wednesday. Spread it on a tray for 10 minutes while you cook the chicken. Cools evenly, stays fluffy.

LUNCH · NO. 07

Greek *Chicken* & Quinoa Bowl

Lunch · 4 servings · 30 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
495 kcal	38 g	42 g	18 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	2 months

INGREDIENTS

600g	chicken breast, diced 2cm
1 cup	(180g) quinoa, uncooked
1 large	cucumber, diced
1 punnet	cherry tomatoes, halved
½	red onion, finely diced
120g	feta, cubed

⅓ cup	(50g) kalamata olives, pitted
2 tbsp	olive oil
1	lemon, zested and juiced
2 tsp	dried oregano
2 cloves	garlic, grated
—	Salt, pepper, fresh parsley

METHOD

1. Rinse quinoa. Cook in 2 cups water for 12–14 minutes until absorbed. Spread on a tray to cool.
2. Combine chicken with 1 tbsp olive oil, lemon zest, oregano, garlic, salt and pepper.
3. Heat remaining oil in a large pan over medium-high. Cook chicken 6–7 minutes until golden and cooked through.
4. Toss cucumber, tomato, onion, olives and feta with lemon juice in a bowl.
5. Divide quinoa between 4 containers. Top with chicken and the vegetable mix.
6. Refrigerate. Add parsley and a drizzle of olive oil on the day.

> PREP TIP *Dress the salad last.*

> If you toss everything together on Sunday, the cucumber waters out and the quinoa turns pink from tomato juice by Wednesday. Keep the dressing separate, or layer: quinoa bottom, chicken middle, salad top.

LUNCH · NO. 08

Thai *Peanut* Chicken Noodle Salad

Lunch · 4 servings · 20 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
510 kcal	35 g	54 g	16 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
3 days	*Don't*

INGREDIENTS

500g	chicken breast
250g	rice vermicelli or flat rice noodles
1	carrot, julienned
½	red capsicum, thinly sliced
1 cup	red cabbage, shredded
1	Lebanese cucumber, julienned

1	Lebanese cucumber, julienned
¼ cup	roasted peanuts, chopped
—	Coriander, spring onion, lime to serve

FOR THE PEANUT DRESSING

3 tbsp	natural peanut butter
2 tbsp	soy sauce
2 tbsp	lime juice
1 tbsp	honey
1 tsp	sesame oil
2 tbsp	warm water
1 clove	garlic + 1 tsp ginger, grated

METHOD

1. Poach chicken in simmering water for 15 minutes. Cool, then shred with two forks.
2. Cook noodles according to packet directions. Rinse under cold water and drain well.
3. Whisk all peanut dressing ingredients in a bowl until smooth.
4. Divide noodles between 4 containers. Top with shredded chicken, carrot, capsicum, cabbage and cucumber.

5 Pack dressing in a small separate container. Keep coriander, peanuts and lime in small snap bags.

6 Toss dressing through just before eating and scatter with peanuts, coriander and a squeeze of lime.

> PREP TIP *Separate, not stacked.*
>
> Dressed noodles go sticky overnight. Pack the dressing and crunchy bits (peanuts, herbs) in their own little snap bags so lunch arrives with the crunch it started with.

LUNCH · NO. 09

Moroccan *Chickpea* & Couscous Salad

Lunch · 4 servings · 15 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
420 kcal	22 g	62 g	10 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	*Don't*

INGREDIENTS

1 cup (200g) couscous

1 cup	(200g) couscous
1 cup	(250ml) boiling vegetable stock
2 × 400g	tins chickpeas, drained
1 punnet	cherry tomatoes, halved
1	Lebanese cucumber, diced
½	red onion, finely diced
80g	baby spinach
80g	feta, crumbled
¼ cup	currants or sultanas
¼ cup	flaked almonds, toasted
—	Fresh mint leaves, torn

FOR THE DRESSING

3 tbsp	olive oil
2 tbsp	lemon juice
1 tsp	Moroccan seasoning
1 tsp	ground cumin
1 clove	garlic, grated

METHOD

1. Place couscous in a bowl, pour over boiling stock, cover and leave 5 minutes. Fluff with a fork.
2. Whisk all dressing ingredients in a large bowl.
3. Add couscous, chickpeas, tomato, cucumber, onion, currants and spinach. Toss well.
4. Divide between 4 containers. Top each with feta, almonds and mint.
5. Seal and refrigerate. Eat cold.

> PREP TIP *Toast the almonds.*
>
> Three minutes in a dry pan. The raw-to-toasted difference is the whole recipe — that's where the nutty depth comes from. Skip this and it's just chickpea salad.

LUNCH · NO. 10

Mexican *Chicken* Fajita Bowl

Lunch · 4 servings · 30 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
535 kcal	40 g	52 g	16 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	2 months

INGREDIENTS

600g	chicken thigh fillets, sliced
2	capsicums (red + yellow), sliced
1	red onion, sliced
1½ cups	(300g) basmati rice, uncooked
1 × 400g	tin black beans, drained
1 cup	corn kernels (tinned or frozen)
1 tbsp	olive oil
2 tbsp	fajita seasoning
1	lime, cut into wedges
—	Coriander, sour cream, salsa to serve

METHOD

1. Cook rice according to packet directions. Spread on a tray to cool.
2. Heat olive oil in a large pan over medium-high. Cook chicken with fajita seasoning for 6–7 minutes until golden.
3. Remove chicken. Add capsicums and onion to the same pan. Cook 5 minutes until softened but still with bite.

4. Return chicken to the pan. Stir in black beans and corn. Warm through for 1 minute.

5. Divide rice between 4 containers. Top with chicken-veg mixture and a lime wedge.

6. Store coriander, sour cream and salsa separately. Add on the day.

> PREP TIP ***Hot pan, don't crowd.***
>
> If your pan's not ripping hot, the capsicums steam instead of char. Work in two batches if you have to. Char is flavour.

LUNCH · NO. 11

Tuna, *White Bean* & Lemon Salad

Lunch · 4 servings · 10 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
410 kcal	34 g	38 g	12 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
3 days	*Don't*

INGREDIENTS

3 × 185g	tins tuna in springwater, drained
2 × 400g	tins cannellini beans, drained
1 punnet	cherry tomatoes, halved
½	red onion, finely diced
1	Lebanese cucumber, diced
80g	rocket or baby spinach
¼ cup	Italian parsley, chopped
¼ cup	capers, drained (optional)

FOR THE DRESSING

¼ cup	(60ml) olive oil
3 tbsp	lemon juice
1	lemon, zested
1 clove	garlic, grated
1 tsp	dijon mustard

METHOD

1. Whisk all dressing ingredients in a large bowl.
2. Flake the tuna into large chunks into the bowl. Don't break it up too finely.

3. Add beans, tomato, onion, cucumber and parsley. Toss gently.
4. Divide between 4 containers. Top with rocket and capers.
5. Refrigerate. Eat cold.

> PREP TIP *Better on day two.*
>
> The beans drink up the dressing overnight and the whole thing tastes more cohesive by Tuesday than it does on Sunday. A genuinely better-as-leftovers lunch.

LUNCH · NO. 12

Pesto *Chicken* Pasta Salad

Lunch · 4 servings · 25 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
565 kcal	40 g	55 g	22 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	*Not rec.*

INGREDIENTS

500g chicken breast

500g	chicken breast
300g	penne or fusilli pasta
1 punnet	cherry tomatoes, halved
200g	bocconcini, torn (or 120g feta)
80g	baby spinach or rocket
¼ cup	pine nuts, toasted
—	Fresh basil leaves

FOR THE PESTO DRESSING

⅓ cup	(90g) basil pesto
3 tbsp	olive oil
2 tbsp	lemon juice
—	Salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Cook pasta in salted water to packet directions. Drain and rinse under cold water until fully cooled.
2. Poach chicken in simmering water for 15 minutes. Cool and slice or shred.
3. Whisk pesto, olive oil, lemon juice, salt and pepper in a large bowl.
4. Add pasta and chicken. Toss to coat.

5 Divide between 4 containers. Top with cherry tomato, bocconcini, spinach and pine nuts.

6 Cover and refrigerate. Eat cold.

> PREP TIP ***Rinse the pasta cold.***
>
> Meal-prep pasta stays loose and doesn't clump when you shock it cold before dressing. Skip this and you'll have a single pasta brick by Wednesday.

DINNER · NO. 13

Slow Cooker *Butter* Chicken

Dinner · 6 servings · 10 min + 6 hr slow cook

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
485 kcal	36 g	28 g	24 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	3 months

INGREDIENTS

1kg	chicken thigh fillets, diced 3cm
1 × 400g	tin diced tomatoes
1 × 400ml	tin coconut cream
1 large	onion, finely diced
4 cloves	garlic, crushed
3cm	ginger, grated
2 tbsp	butter chicken paste

1 tbsp	tomato paste
1 tsp	sugar
—	Salt, pepper, coriander to serve
1 cup	basmati rice to serve

METHOD

1. Add onion, garlic, ginger, butter chicken paste and tomato paste to the slow cooker. Stir.
2. Add chicken, diced tomatoes, coconut cream, sugar and a pinch of salt. Stir to combine.
3. Cook on LOW for 6 hours (or HIGH for 3–4 hours) until chicken is tender and sauce has thickened.
4. Taste and season with salt and pepper.
5. Cook rice according to packet directions closer to eating time.
6. Divide chicken between 6 containers with rice separate. Top with coriander before eating.

> PREP TIP ***Freeze it flat.***
>
> Butter chicken freezes better than almost any other dinner — but only if you freeze it flat in the container. Stacked containers in the freezer take twice as long to thaw.

DINNER · NO. 14

Turkey & *Zucchini* Meatballs

Dinner · 5 servings (4 each) · 35 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
425 kcal	38 g	28 g	18 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	3 months

INGREDIENTS

750g	turkey mince (or chicken mince)
2	zucchini, grated and squeezed dry
1	egg
½ cup	(50g) breadcrumbs
40g	parmesan, grated
2 cloves	garlic, grated
2 tbsp	parsley, chopped
1 tsp	dried oregano
1 tbsp	olive oil

—	Salt and pepper

FOR THE MARINARA

1 × 700g	passata
1 tbsp	olive oil
1	onion, finely diced
2 cloves	garlic, grated
1 tsp	sugar
1 tsp	dried oregano

METHOD

1. Squeeze grated zucchini in a clean tea towel to remove moisture.
2. Mix zucchini with mince, egg, breadcrumbs, parmesan, garlic, parsley, oregano, salt and pepper. Roll into 20 meatballs.
3. Heat olive oil in a large pan over medium. Brown meatballs in batches for 3–4 minutes per side. Remove.
4. Same pan: add olive oil and onion. Cook 5 minutes until soft. Add garlic, cook 1 minute.
5. Pour in passata, add sugar and oregano. Simmer 5 minutes.
6. Return meatballs to the sauce. Simmer 10 minutes until cooked through.

7 Divide between 5 containers. Cool, then refrigerate or freeze.

> PREP TIP *Squeeze the zucchini. Twice.*
>
> Two tea towels worth of liquid come out of two zucchinis — and if you skip this step, your meatballs fall apart in the pan. It's the single most important move in the recipe.

DINNER · NO. 15

Beef & *Black Bean* Chilli

Dinner · 6 servings · 45 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
445 kcal	34 g	38 g	16 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	3 months

INGREDIENTS

750g	lean beef mince
1 large	onion, diced
1	capsicum, diced

1	capsicum, diced
4 cloves	garlic, crushed
2 × 400g	tins black beans, drained
1 × 400g	tin kidney beans, drained
1 × 400g	tin diced tomatoes
1 × 400g	tin crushed tomatoes
2 tbsp	tomato paste
2 tbsp	chilli powder
1 tbsp	ground cumin
1 tsp	smoked paprika
1 tsp	dried oregano
1 cup	(250ml) beef stock
—	Sour cream, avocado, coriander to serve

METHOD

1. Heat a large heavy pot over medium-high. Brown mince in batches, breaking it up. Remove.

2. Add onion and capsicum to the pot. Cook 5 minutes until soft. Add garlic, cook 1 minute.

3. Stir in chilli powder, cumin, paprika, oregano and tomato paste. Cook 30 seconds until fragrant.

4. Return mince to the pot. Add both tins of tomatoes, beans and stock. Stir well.

5. Simmer uncovered for 30 minutes, stirring occasionally, until thickened.

6. Season with salt and pepper. Divide between 6 containers.

> PREP TIP *Tomorrow's version is better.*
>
> Chilli is one of those rare dishes that's actively better on day two — the spices settle, the beans drink the sauce, everything gets richer. Make it Sunday, eat it Monday onwards.

DINNER · NO. 16

One-Pan *Lemon* Garlic Salmon

Dinner · 4 servings · 40 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
585 kcal	42 g	38 g	28 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
3 days	*Don't*

INGREDIENTS

4 × 150g	salmon fillets, skin on
600g	baby potatoes, halved
2 cups	(160g) broccoli florets
3 tbsp	olive oil
4 cloves	garlic, sliced
2	lemons (1 sliced, 1 juiced)
2 tsp	dried oregano
—	Salt, pepper, dill or parsley

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 200°C fan-forced. Line a large baking tray with baking paper.
2. Toss potatoes with 1 tbsp olive oil, salt and pepper. Spread on the tray and roast for 20 minutes.
3. Add broccoli and garlic to the tray with another 1 tbsp oil. Toss. Make space for the salmon.
4. Pat salmon dry and place on the tray. Top with lemon slices. Drizzle with remaining oil, lemon juice and oregano.
5. Roast 12–14 minutes until salmon is just cooked through and flakes easily.
6. Divide between 4 containers. Cool fully before sealing.

PREP TIP *Eat by Wednesday.*

Cooked salmon is at its best for 2 days, acceptable to day 3, and past that it gets fishy and sad. Don't try to stretch this one to Friday — it's not that kind of recipe.

DINNER · NO. 17

Aussie *Zucchini* Slice

Dinner or lunch · 6 servings · 50 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
315 kcal	22 g	18 g	18 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	2 months

INGREDIENTS

5	eggs
1 cup	(150g) self-raising flour
3	zucchinis, coarsely grated

1 large	onion, finely diced
200g	bacon, chopped
120g	tasty cheese, grated
¼ cup	(60ml) olive oil
—	Salt, pepper, chives to serve

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 170°C fan-forced. Line a 20×30cm baking dish with baking paper.
2. Squeeze excess moisture from grated zucchini using a clean tea towel.
3. In a large bowl, whisk eggs. Add flour and whisk until smooth.
4. Stir in zucchini, onion, bacon, cheese, olive oil, salt and pepper.
5. Pour into the prepared dish and smooth the top.
6. Bake 35–40 minutes until golden and set in the middle.
7. Cool in the tin for 10 minutes, then slice into 6 portions. Scatter with chives.

> PREP TIP *The Aussie lunchbox hero.*
>
> Zucchini slice is the meal prep equivalent of a Swiss army knife — breakfast hot, lunch cold, dinner with salad. Cut it into 6, wrap

> individually, you've got a week of grab-and-go.

DINNER · NO. 18

Chicken, *Chorizo* & Rice One-Pot

Dinner · 5 servings · 45 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
595 kcal	38 g	62 g	22 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	2 months

INGREDIENTS

500g	chicken thigh fillets, diced
200g	chorizo, sliced 5mm
1½ cups	(300g) long grain rice
3 cups	(750ml) chicken stock
1 × 400g	tin diced tomatoes
1	red capsicum, diced
1	onion, diced

4 cloves	garlic, crushed
1 tbsp	smoked paprika
1 tsp	dried oregano
1 cup	frozen peas
—	Olive oil, salt, pepper, parsley

METHOD

1. Heat a splash of oil in a large deep pan or heavy pot over medium-high. Cook chorizo 3 minutes until golden. Remove.
2. Brown chicken in the chorizo oil for 5 minutes. Remove.
3. Add onion and capsicum. Cook 5 minutes. Add garlic, paprika and oregano. Cook 30 seconds.
4. Stir in rice, coating well. Pour in stock and diced tomatoes. Bring to a boil.
5. Return chicken and chorizo. Stir, reduce heat to low, cover. Simmer 18 minutes.
6. Stir through peas. Cover and rest off heat for 5 minutes.
7. Divide between 5 containers. Top with parsley. Cool before sealing.

> PREP TIP *Don't peek.*

> The urge to lift the lid and check is strong. Resist it. The rice needs the trapped steam to cook through evenly. If you peek, you lose steam, you lose rice texture.

SNACKS & SIDES · NO. 19

Aussie *Bliss* Balls

Snack · 12 balls (2 per serving) · 10 min + 30 min chill

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
185 kcal	5 g	22 g	8 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
1 week	2 months

INGREDIENTS

1½ cups	(135g) rolled oats
½ cup	(130g) natural peanut butter
⅓ cup	(115g) honey or maple syrup
¼ cup	(30g) cocoa powder
¼ cup	(40g) dark chocolate chips
2 tbsp	chia seeds
1 tsp	vanilla extract
—	Desiccated coconut, for rolling (optional)

METHOD

1. Combine all ingredients in a large bowl. Stir well until you have a thick, sticky dough.

2. If the mixture is too wet, add a tbsp more oats. Too dry, add 1 tsp warm water.

3. Chill the mixture for 20 minutes in the fridge — easier to roll.
4. Roll tablespoons of mixture into 12 balls. Roll in coconut if using.
5. Store in a container, stacked with baking paper between layers.

> PREP TIP *Freeze half from the start.*
>
> Bliss balls are dangerous in the fridge — they disappear. Freeze 6 of them so you have emergency snacks for days when you forgot to pack one.

SNACKS & SIDES · NO. 20

Rosemary *Roasted* Pumpkin & Sweet Potato

Side · 6 servings · 40 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
185 kcal	3 g	34 g	5 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	*Don't*

INGREDIENTS

800g	butternut pumpkin, diced 3cm
800g	sweet potato, diced 2cm
1	red onion, cut into wedges
3 tbsp	olive oil
2 tbsp	fresh rosemary, chopped
4 cloves	garlic, crushed
1 tsp	smoked paprika
—	Salt and pepper

METHOD

1. Preheat oven to 200°C fan-forced. Line two large baking trays with baking paper.
2. Combine pumpkin, sweet potato and onion in a large bowl. Drizzle with olive oil. Add rosemary, garlic, paprika, salt and pepper. Toss well.
3. Spread across both trays in a single layer — don't crowd, or they'll steam.
4. Roast 30–35 minutes, turning halfway, until caramelised and tender.
5. Cool completely before dividing into containers for the week.

> PREP TIP *Size matters.*

> Pumpkin and sweet potato have different cook times. Cut the pumpkin slightly larger (3cm) and sweet potato slightly smaller (2cm) — they'll finish together. Guessed wrong, pumpkin will be mush when sweet potato is done.

SNACKS & SIDES · NO. 21

Lemon *Tahini* Broccoli

Side · 6 servings · 15 min total

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
125 kcal	5 g	12 g	8 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
4 days	*Don't*

INGREDIENTS

800g	broccoli, cut into florets
2 tbsp	olive oil
2 cloves	garlic, sliced
¼ cup	(35g) almonds or pine nuts
—	Salt, pepper, parsley to serve

FOR THE TAHINI DRESSING

3 tbsp	tahini (hulled, smooth)
3 tbsp	lemon juice
3 tbsp	warm water
1 clove	garlic, grated
1 tsp	honey

METHOD

1. Blanch broccoli in boiling salted water for 90 seconds. Drain and plunge into ice water. Drain well.
2. Heat olive oil in a large pan over medium-high. Add sliced garlic and cook 30 seconds until golden.
3. Add broccoli and char 2–3 minutes for colour. Season with salt and pepper.
4. Whisk all tahini dressing ingredients until smooth. Thin with more water if needed.
5. Divide broccoli between 6 containers. Pack dressing separately.
6. Drizzle with dressing and scatter almonds and parsley before eating.

> PREP TIP ***Ice bath, not a cold rinse.***
>
> Blanched broccoli needs to be actively cold-shocked, not just

> Blanched broccoli needs to be actively cold-shocked, not just rinsed, or it keeps cooking from residual heat and goes army-green. That bowl of iced water is the whole reason this stays bright all week.

SNACKS & SIDES · NO. 22

Cottage Cheese & *Berry* Protein Pots

Snack · 4 servings · 5 min assembly

ENERGY	PROTEIN	CARBS	FAT
245 kcal	22 g	22 g	6 g

FRIDGE	FREEZER
3 days	*Don't*

INGREDIENTS

500g	cottage cheese
2 cups	(300g) mixed berries
4 tbsp	honey or maple syrup
½ cup	(40g) granola
2 tbsp	chia seeds
1	lemon, zested (optional)

- Fresh mint leaves (optional)

METHOD

1. Divide cottage cheese evenly between 4 containers.
2. Sprinkle chia seeds over each portion.
3. Top with berries, drizzle honey, and finish with a small handful of granola.
4. Add lemon zest and mint if using.
5. Seal and refrigerate.

> PREP TIP ***Pack the granola separately.***
>
> Mixed in, granola goes soft overnight — exactly what you don't want in a crunchy topping. A small snap bag of granola added at breakfast keeps every bite crisp.

REFERENCE · NO. 01

How long does it *really* keep?

Safe-to-eat windows and quality windows aren't the same thing. The numbers below are when food is still worth eating — not just legally safe. Err towards the shorter end.

FOOD	FRIDGE	FREEZER
COOKED PROTEINS		
Chicken (cooked)	3–4 days	3 months
Beef, pork, turkey (cooked)	3–4 days	3 months
Salmon, white fish (cooked)	2–3 days	2 months
Mince-based dishes (chilli, bolognese)	4 days	3 months

GRAINS & LEGUMES		
Cooked rice	4 days	1 month
Cooked quinoa, couscous	5 days	2 months
Cooked pasta (plain)	4 days	2 months
Cooked beans, lentils	4 days	2 months
EGGS & EGG DISHES		
Boiled eggs (in shell)	1 week	*Don't*
Egg muffins, zucchini slice, frittata	4 days	2 months
VEGETABLES		
Steamed or roasted	3–4 days	1 month
Raw cut salad veg	3 days	*Don't*
SAUCES & FINISHED MEALS		
Oil-based dressings	5 days	*Don't*
Dairy-based dressings (yoghurt, tahini)	3 days	*Don't*
Soups, stews, curries	4 days	3 months

REFERENCE · NO. 02

Reheat so it tastes like *day one.*

Most meal prep fails at reheating, not cooking. Pick the right method for the dish and it tastes fresh on Thursday.

METHOD 01 · DEFAULT

The *microwave*, done right.

- Lid off, always. Trapped steam turns food soggy.
- 70% power, 60 seconds. Stir. 60 more. Stir again.
- High power cooks the outside before warming the inside.
- Dry foods (rice, slices): add a damp paper towel on top.

METHOD 02 · FOR SAUCY DISHES

Back to the *stovetop*.

- Curries, chilli, stews, bolognese.
- Low heat, splash of water, 4–5 minutes, stir often.
- Restores the sauce body that microwaves destroy.
- Worth the extra 90 seconds. Trust.

METHOD 03 · FOR CRISPY ORIGINALS

Revive in the *oven*.

- Zucchini slice, frittata, egg muffins, bakes.
- 160°C, 10 minutes from cold.
- Gets the top back to lightly crisp instead of wet.
- Batch: heat four portions at once.

METHOD 04 · NO REHEAT

Eat it *cold*.

- Salads, grain bowls, pasta salad, overnight oats.
- Yoghurt pots, chia pudding, bliss balls.
- If the recipe says "eat cold" — it means it.
- Reheated salad is always worse than cold salad.

HANDLE WITH CARE · THE ONES THAT DON'T FIT THE RULES

Salmon: oven 140°C for 8 min, or eat cold.

Hard-boiled eggs: always cold. Microwave = rubber.

Fresh herbs: add *after* reheating, never before.

Avocado: always fresh, never reheated or pre-cut.

REFERENCE · NO. 03

The *swap* chart.

Run out of something? Don't abandon the recipe. Here's what trades one-for-one without breaking the result.

CATEGORY 01

Protein swaps.

Chicken breast ↔ chicken thigh (thigh holds better for prep)

Beef mince ↔ turkey, chicken or pork mince

Salmon ↔ ocean trout or firm white fish

Tinned tuna ↔ tinned salmon or sardines

Chickpeas ↔ cannellini or butter beans

Feta ↔ goat's cheese or ricotta salata

CATEGORY 02

Carb swaps.

White rice ↔ brown rice, quinoa or couscous

Pasta ↔ noodles or orzo

Potato ↔ sweet potato or pumpkin

Tortillas ↔ wraps or lettuce cups (low carb)

Breadcrumbs ↔ panko or almond meal

Rolled oats ↔ quick oats (slightly softer)

CATEGORY 03

Fat & richness swaps.

Olive oil ↔ avocado oil (heat-stable)

Butter ↔ ghee (same)

Pine nuts ↔ almonds, cashews or walnuts

Basil pesto ↔ blend basil, oil, garlic, parmesan

CATEGORY 04

Dairy swaps.

Regular milk ↔ oat, almond or soy milk

Greek yoghurt ↔ sour cream or coconut yoghurt

Sour cream ↔ Greek yoghurt (for cold dishes)

Cream cheese ↔ ricotta or cottage cheese

FLAVOUR SAVES · WHEN YOU'VE RUN OUT OF THE AROMATICS

No fresh garlic: 1 tsp powder per 2 cloves.

No fresh herbs: ⅓ of the amount in dried.

No lemon juice: 1 tbsp white vinegar (less acid).

No tomato paste: 2 tbsp passata + 1 tsp sugar.

REFERENCE · NO. 04

Two hours, one *Sunday.*

A cook-once-eat-all-week blueprint. Pick three recipes — one breakfast, one lunch, one dinner — follow this timeline, and you're done by lunch.

0:00

Oven on. *Read everything.*

Oven to 200°C. Read all three recipes end to end before you touch a knife. Nothing kills a prep session faster than discovering step five at step two.

0:05

Start the *longest* thing.

Roasted vegetables into the oven, or slow cooker on if you're making butter chicken or chilli. Anything that cooks itself while you do other things goes on first.

0:15

Grains on the boil.

Rice, quinoa, or pasta water. Set a timer. Grains don't care

about you, they'll ruin themselves the moment you look away.

0:25

Chop *everything*.

All veg for the entire week, in one session. Each recipe's ingredients in their own bowl. Chopping is the task you never want to re-do on a Tuesday night.

0:40

Grains: *spread to cool.*

Onto trays, even layer. Hot grains in containers steam themselves to mush by Wednesday. This step is non-negotiable.

0:45

Cook the *proteins*.

Order: chicken first (longest), beef/turkey second, fish last (quickest and most delicate). Rest each on a board while the next goes in the pan.

1:15

Sauces & dressings.

Each into its own small jar or container. Never mixed through ahead of time. Sunday you trusts Monday you to add dressing at lunch.

1:30

Assemble the *containers*.

Layer: grains bottom, protein middle, veg top. Sauces separate. Label each with the eat-day if you're splitting between a few different dishes.

1:45

Cool *uncovered*. 15 minutes.

Lids off on the bench. Steam rises out instead of back into the food. Fifteen minutes, no shortcuts. This is the difference

between fresh-tasting Thursday lunch and watery Thursday lunch.

2:00 ***Lids on.*** **Fridge. Done.**

Week is handled. Go do something that isn't cooking.

FROM THE HOLLIS KITCHEN

Eat well this *week.* And the one *after.*

Twenty-five recipes, four containers at a time. Real food that shows up on Wednesday tasting like it's supposed to.

If these containers have earned their spot on your kitchen bench, we'd love to hear about it. A few honest words from you helps another Aussie find Hollis.

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